Day 49 - Len Gertler

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Beaver Valley section · hike 59 · Loree Forest

12.1 km / 7.5 mi	~3.9 h	1.4 km new	116 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

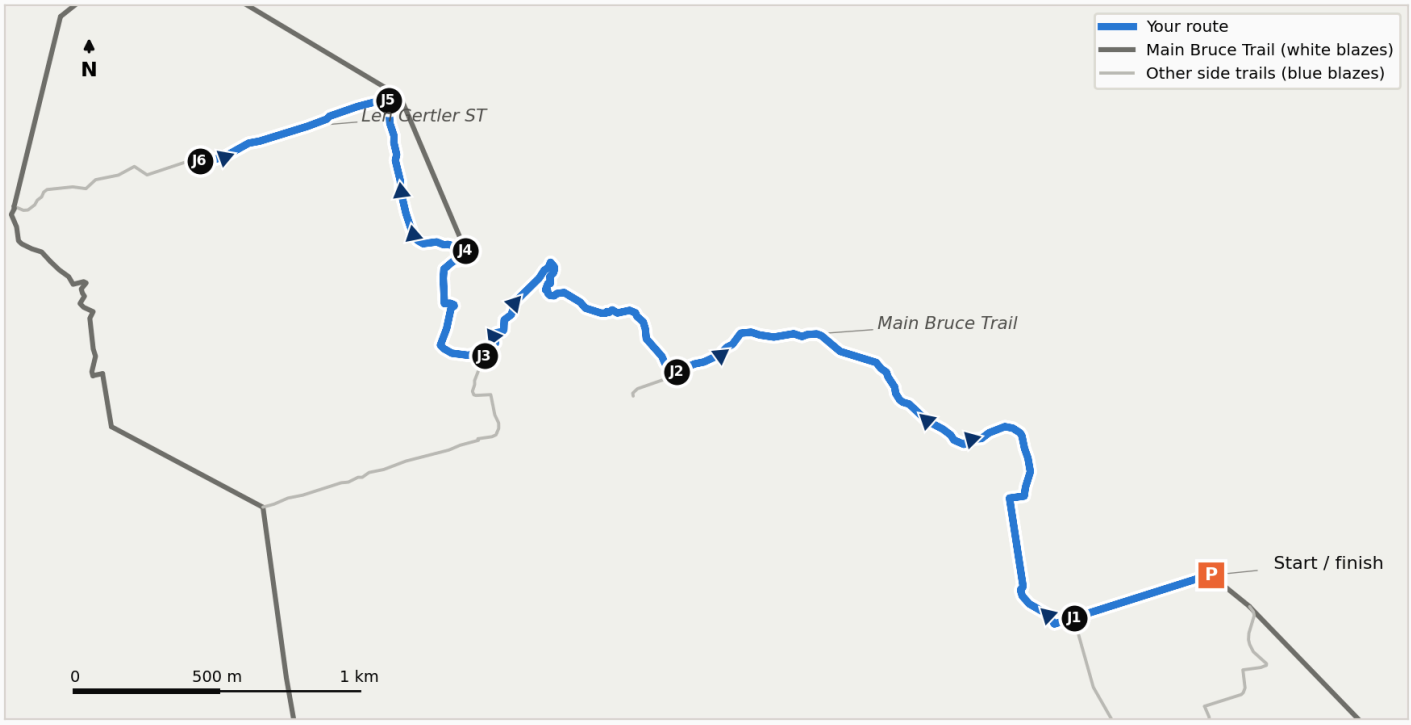
Park (P): Roadside parking along the north side of Maple Lane. Parking is prohibited on the south side of the road. Do not to block driveways. Google Maps. **Free**

Side trails covered: Len Gertler Side Trail (1.4 km)

Navigate: import *day49_hike059.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Route map

Day 49 | 12.1 km (7.5 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside on the **north side** of Maple Lane only; parking is prohibited on the south side. Do not block driveways.
- **Road walking:** The route begins and ends on a road section of the main Bruce Trail. Walk on the shoulder and keep Zappy close.
- **Main Bruce Trail:** White-blazed. A trail guide describes it dropping through a steep valley and climbing to a ridge with views north, then running west near the top of the private Georgian Peaks ski club.
- **Len Gertler Memorial Loree Forest:** The Len Gertler Side Trail (blue blazes) loops through this forest, named for an environmentalist who helped shape the Niagara Escarpment Plan. A trip report calls it well maintained and well marked, mostly level with exposed roots and rocks; a clearing and wooden platform at the north end normally give views of Georgian Bay.
- **Length:** At about 12.3 km this is a full day; most of it is on the main trail getting to and from the Len Gertler loop.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking along the north side of Maple Lane. Head west on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail. The next 0.6 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
0.5	0.3	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Swiss Meadows Side Trail goes off on your left.)

2.8	1.7	J2: Junction. Turn right to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north-west. (the blue-blazed Intercept Side Trail goes off ahead.)
4.0	2.5	J3: Junction. Turn right to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Loree Side Trail goes off ahead.)
4.6	2.9	J4: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Len Gertler Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
5.3	3.3	J5: Junction. Turn left to stay on the Len Gertler Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Len Gertler Connector Side Trail goes off on your right.)
6.0	3.7	J6: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
6.7	4.2	J5: Junction. Turn right to stay on the Len Gertler Side Trail, heading south. (the blue-blazed Len Gertler Connector Side Trail goes off ahead.)
7.4	4.6	J4: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
8.0	5.0	J3: Junction. Turn left to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed Loree Side Trail goes off on your right.)
9.3	5.8	J2: Junction. Turn left to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Intercept Side Trail goes off on your right.)
11.5	7.1	Heads-up: The next 0.6 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
11.6	7.2	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Swiss Meadows Side Trail goes off on your right.)
12.1	7.5	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Nature Trails and Ontario Hiking.